After the White Winter

Field report · Arkhangai Province, Mongolia · Example upload for the demo

In Mongolia a dzud is a winter so harsh that grazing animals cannot reach the grass. A dry summer leaves too little hay, then deep snow and weeks of extreme cold seal the pasture under ice. In the winter of 2024 millions of goats, sheep, horses and cattle died across the country, and families who live entirely from their herds lost most of what they owned.

The project follows three herding families in Arkhangai from the first heavy snow to the spring thaw. It shows the daily work of keeping animals alive: digging through the snow to reach grass, sheltering newborn lambs inside the ger, and waiting for the trucks that bring emergency hay from the provincial centre.

In spring the families count what is left. Some rebuild their herds with loans and help from relatives. Others sell the remaining animals and move to the ger districts on the edge of Ulaanbaatar, joining many former herders looking for work in the city. Climate change is making these winters more frequent.

Method

The photographer stayed with the families for four visits between December and April, travelling with a local interpreter. Interviews were recorded with consent, and families chose which photographs could be published.

This document is a synthetic example made to demonstrate The Charter's upload. The families and the photographer are fictional.